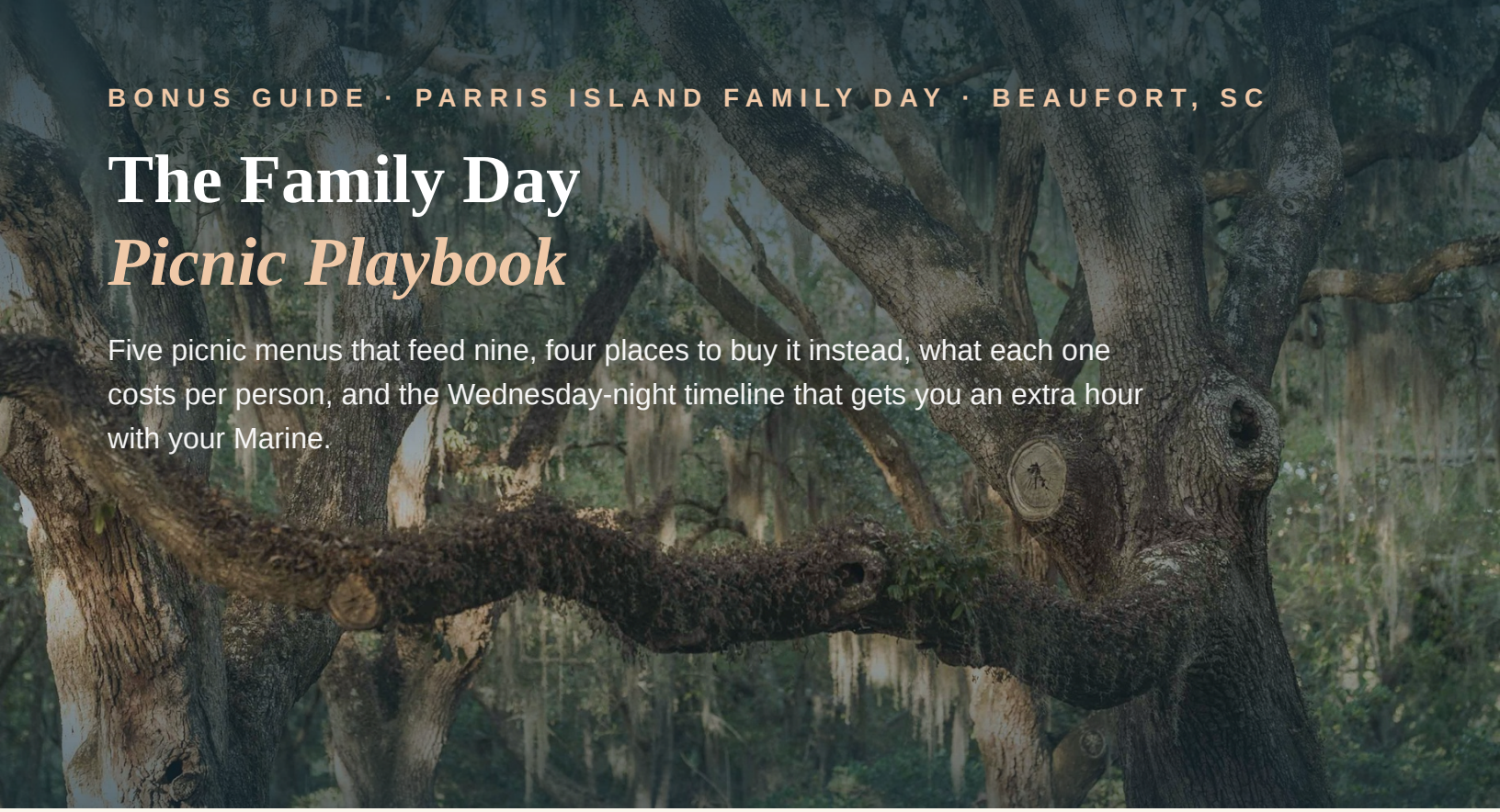


BONUS GUIDE · PARRIS ISLAND FAMILY DAY · BEAUFORT, SC

The Family Day *Picnic Playbook*

Five picnic menus that feed nine, four places to buy it instead, what each one costs per person, and the Wednesday-night timeline that gets you an extra hour with your Marine.

WHY A PICNIC

Thursday liberty runs 10 a.m. to 3 p.m., your new Marine can't leave the Depot, and every family on base wants lunch at the same handful of counters at the same time. The families who bring a cooler and spread out on the lawn skip the line and get the hour back.

Everything below is sized for nine people, with what to buy, how much, where, and what it costs. Prices are Beaufort-area estimates as of November 2026 — confirm when you order.

5 hrs
LIBERTY, 10 AM–3 PM

9
EVERY MENU FEEDS THIS MANY

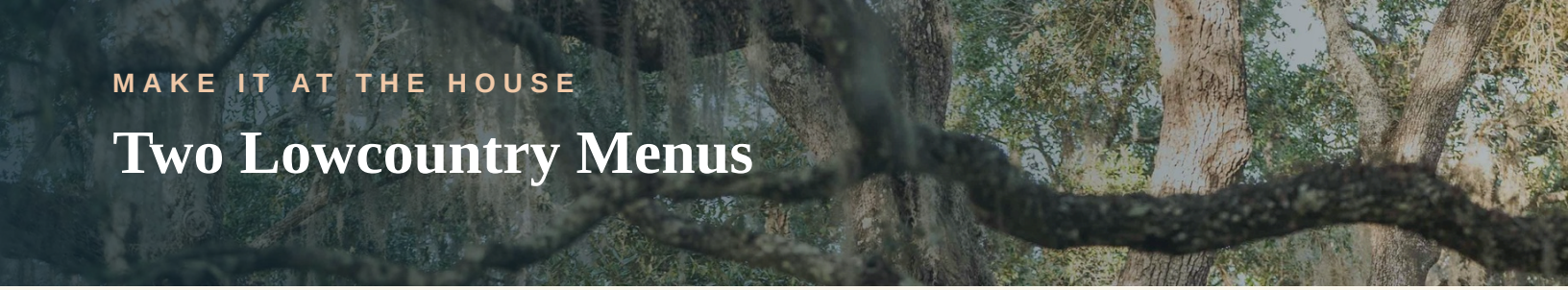
$4–14
PER PERSON, COOK VS. BUY

24 hrs
NOTICE MOST CATERING NEEDS

01 Shrimp-Salad Croissants
02 Fried Chicken & Pimento Cheese
03 Build-Your-Own Wrap Bar
04 Pulled-Pork Sliders
05 The No-Mayo Mezze Board
06 Publix Deli Platters
07 Chick-fil-A Trays
08 Jersey Mike's Sub Boxes
09 Chipotle by the Box
10 Cook vs. Buy: The Math

- Make it at the house
- Buy it on the way

All four pickup options sit on the Robert Smalls Parkway / Boundary Street corridor between downtown Beaufort and the Parris Island gate.



MAKE IT AT THE HOUSE

Two Lowcountry Menus

1 Shrimp-Salad Croissants

about $8 / person *The Lowcountry One*

PREP 30 MIN WEDNESDAY NIGHT · NO COOKING · KEEP COLD

Chopped cooked shrimp folded into mayo, celery, lemon and a little Old Bay, piled onto croissants at the picnic (not before, or they go soft). It travels well, it feels like Beaufort, and nobody has to stand at a stove the night before graduation.

Buy for 9: 2 lb peeled, cooked shrimp (deli counter) · 10 croissants · 1 bunch celery · 2 lemons · mayo · Old Bay · 2 lb grapes · 2 big bags kettle chips · 1 box cookies. **About $70 total.**

> **INSIDER TIP** Mix the salad Wednesday night, pack it in a sealed container on ice, and bring the croissants in their bag. Assemble on the blanket — it takes two minutes and the bread stays crisp.

2 Fried Chicken & Pimento Cheese

about $6 / person *The Southern One*

PREP 10 MIN · BUY THE CHICKEN, MAKE NOTHING · SERVED COLD

Cold fried chicken is a Southern picnic tradition for a reason: it's better the next day and it needs no plates. Add a tub of pimento cheese with crackers, deviled eggs if someone in the family makes them, and a watermelon. Everyone eats with their hands and the conversation never stops.

Buy for 9: 24-piece fried chicken from the Publix deli (order chilled, or buy hot Wednesday and refrigerate) · 2 tubs pimento cheese · 2 boxes crackers · 1 dozen eggs if you're making deviled eggs · 1 watermelon or 2 lb strawberries · sweet tea. **About $55 total.**

> **INSIDER TIP** Ask the deli for the chicken "chilled, for a picnic tomorrow" — they'll pack it cold so it goes straight from the fridge to the cooler at 6 a.m.

WHERE TO PACK IT · HATTIE'S PLACE, BEAUFORT

The Picnic Kit is already in the house. So is the table for ten.

Two coolers, blankets, chairs for the grandparents, service for twelve and the jugs are waiting by the back door. Lay everything out Wednesday night, and Thursday morning is just loading the car.

Family Day Picnic Kit for 9 · Full Kitchen · 20 Minutes to the Gate · Book Direct

misshattiesplace.com
Scan or visit to see availability



Two That Travel Well

3 Build-Your-Own Wrap Bar

about $5 / person *The Picky-Eater Proof One*

PREP 15 MIN · NO COOKING · EVERYONE BUILDS THEIR OWN

Deli turkey and ham, sliced cheese, lettuce, tomato, a few spreads and a stack of large tortillas. Nobody argues about mayo, the teenagers eat three, and the leftovers make Friday's road-trip lunch.

Buy for 9: 1.5 lb sliced turkey + 1 lb ham · 1 lb sliced cheddar/provolone · 2 packs large flour tortillas (20) · romaine, 3 tomatoes, 1 red onion · mayo, mustard, ranch · pretzels · apples. **About $45 total.**

> **INSIDER TIP** Slice the tomato and onion the night before and bag them; bring the lettuce whole and tear it on the blanket. Wet ingredients in bags, dry on top.

4 Pulled-Pork Sliders

about $4 / person *The Cheapest & Most Impressive*

8 HRS IN A SLOW COOKER, UNATTENDED · SERVE WARM OR ROOM TEMP

A pork shoulder in a slow cooker Wednesday morning is dinner for the family Wednesday night *and* sliders for Thursday. Pack the pulled pork in a sealed container, the slaw in another, and the rolls in their bag. Sauce at the picnic.

Buy for 9 (with Wednesday dinner): 6–7 lb pork shoulder · 1 bottle BBQ rub or brown sugar + paprika + salt · 2 bottles sauce · 2 bags slaw mix + 1 bottle slaw dressing · 24 slider rolls · pickles · baked beans (canned). **About $40 total.**

> **INSIDER TIP** Start it before Wednesday's orientation and it's done when you get back. If the kitchen has no slow cooker, a covered roasting pan at 300°F for 5 hours does the same job.



THE HOT-DAY MENU & THE EASY DEFAULT

One to Cook, One to Pick Up

5 The No-Mayo Mezze Board

about $6 / person *The Hot-Day One*

PREP 15 MIN · NO COOKING · SAFE IN THE HEAT

For an August graduation, skip anything with mayo. Two rotisserie chickens pulled into strips, hummus, pita, cucumbers, cherry tomatoes, olives, feta and a lot of fruit. It holds up on a 95° day and it's the menu grandparents thank you for.

Buy for 9: 2 rotisserie chickens · 2 large tubs hummus · 2 packs pita · 3 cucumbers, 2 pints cherry tomatoes · 1 jar olives · 1 tub feta · 1 whole pineapple or 3 lb mixed fruit · pita chips. **About $55 total.**

> **INSIDER TIP** Pull the chicken Wednesday night while it's warm — it takes five minutes then and twenty when it's cold.

6 Publix Deli Platters

about $10 / person *The Easy Default*

33 ROBERT SMALLS PKWY · OPENS 7 AM · 24 HOURS' NOTICE FOR PLATTERS

Order online for in-store pickup Wednesday evening: a medium chicken tender platter (serves about 18, roughly $40), a medium fruit platter (about $35), a sub or wrap platter sized small, and a cookie tray (about $19). Publix is on the way to the gate, so a Thursday 6:45 a.m. grab of ice and drinks works too.

> **INSIDER TIP** Platters need 24 hours' notice, so order them Tuesday for a Wednesday pickup. Ask for the tenders chilled; they're built for exactly this.

THE TIMELINE · FROM WEDNESDAY AFTERNOON TO THE LAWN

WEDNESDAY 3 PM

Shop → Prep → Chill

After the orientation brief, hit Publix on Robert Smalls Parkway on the way home. Prep anything that needs it, sealed containers in the fridge, ice packs in the freezer, two bags of ice in the chest freezer.

WEDNESDAY 9 PM

Pack the Dry Bin

Blankets, 4 chairs, service for 12, paper towels, wipes, trash bags, sunscreen, bug spray, the jugs (empty). Load the car tonight; only the cooler waits.

THURSDAY 6 AM

Cooler → Gate by 6:30

Food on ice, drinks in the second cooler, jugs filled. Cooler stays closed for the vehicle search. Sign in at the DVC before 9:50; eat at liberty, 10–3.



BUY IT ON THE WAY

Pickups Between the House and the Gate

7 Chick-fil-A Trays

about $9–11 / person *The Crowd-Pleaser*

2405 BOUNDARY ST · OPENS 6:30 AM · CLOSED SUNDAY

A medium nugget tray is 120 pieces for roughly $55–67 and feeds the whole table; add a fruit tray and a gallon of lemonade. Small orders can be placed in the app for a scheduled pickup the same day, which makes this the best option if you decide on Wednesday night.

> **INSIDER TIP** Order the chilled tray for Wednesday evening pickup and skip the 6:30 a.m. drive-through line on Thursday, when every other family has the same idea.

8 Jersey Mike's Sub Boxes

about $10–12 / person *The Road-Trip Classic*

272 ROBERT SMALLS PKWY · OPENS 10 AM · CALL (843) 379-8820

Subs by the box, cut into halves, travel better than almost anything and need no plates. Call the day before, pick up Wednesday after 10, and keep them cold overnight. Add chips and cookies from Publix next door.

> **INSIDER TIP** Ask for "Mike's Way" on half the box and plain on the other half; that settles the pickle debate before it starts.

WHAT'S IN THE PICNIC KIT AT HATTIE'S PLACE

KEEP IT COLD

2 coolers · 4 ice packs

One hard cooler for food, one soft for drinks. Ice packs live in the freezer; add two bags of ice from Publix for a hot month.

SIT AND SERVE

2 blankets · 4 chairs · service for 12

Two big blankets, chairs for anyone who shouldn't sit on the ground, plates, cups and utensils for twelve, serving spoons, a cutting board and knife.

THE SMALL STUFF

Jugs · towels · bags

Two one-gallon jugs, paper towels, wipes, trash bags, sunscreen, bug spray. Please return it all to the bin by the back door for the next family.



BUY IT ON THE WAY

The Last Pickup, and the Math

9 Chipotle by the Box

about $10–14 / person *The One That Needs a Table*

21 ROBERT SMALLS PKWY · OPENS 10:45 AM · 24 HOURS' NOTICE

Burritos by the Box run about $9–11 each (six minimum); the Build-Your-Own spread is about $12–13.50 a head with a ten-person minimum. Burritos picnic well; the spread needs a flat surface and serving spoons, so it's better on a picnic table than a blanket.

> **INSIDER TIP** Chipotle doesn't open until 10:45, so this is a Wednesday-pickup, reheat-at-the-house, pack-cold plan, not a Thursday-morning one.

10 Cook vs. Buy vs. Stand in Line *Per Person, for Nine*

BEAUFORT-AREA ESTIMATES, NOVEMBER 2026 · CONFIRM WHEN YOU ORDER

OPTION	PER PERSON	YOUR TIME	BEST WHEN
Cook at the house (menus 1–5)	$4–8	30–60 min Wednesday	You have a full kitchen and a big table — and want the best food
Publix platters	about $10	10 min pickup	You decided on Tuesday and want zero prep
Chick-fil-A trays	$9–11	10 min pickup	Kids in the group; deciding late Wednesday
Jersey Mike's / Chipotle boxes	$10–14	10 min pickup	You want sandwiches/burritos and have a picnic table
Walk up to the food court on base	$12–15	30–45 min in line, of your 5 hours	You forgot. (The MCCS Family Day pizza & wings pre-order is the on-base shortcut.)

BASE RULES FOR THE BLANKET

NO GLASS, NO ALCOHOL
Your Marine cannot drink on liberty and the vehicle is searched at the gate. Cans and plastic only; sweet tea and lemonade in the jugs.

PACK IT IN, PACK IT OUT
Bring two trash bags and leave the lawn the way you found it. The Depot is immaculate and the Marines notice.

HEAT, APRIL–SEPTEMBER
Keep mayo dishes on ice until the moment you serve, and go with menu 5 on the hottest days. A gallon of water per three people is not too much.

Enjoy the hour. Independently produced by Hattie's Place / Assured Comfort Homes, LLC; not affiliated with the United States Marine Corps, MCRD Parris Island, Publix, Chick-fil-A, Jersey Mike's, Chipotle or any business named here. Prices and hours are Beaufort-area estimates as of November 2026 and change without notice; confirm when you order. Food-safety rule of thumb: keep cold food below 40°F and nothing out of the cooler for more than two hours (one hour above 90°F).